

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1027

By Littleton

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the local emergency management agencies of Tennessee for their meritorious service.

WHEREAS, the safety, resilience, and well-being of Tennesseans depend in large measure on the continuous efforts of local emergency management agencies, whose personnel stand prepared to protect life and property in times of crisis; and

WHEREAS, local emergency management agencies provide essential "blue-sky" capabilities and day-to-day readiness functions that strengthen communities, including hazard identification, risk reduction planning, training, exercises, public outreach, and collaboration with local officials, schools, healthcare facilities, and volunteer and faith-based partners; and

WHEREAS, these agencies lead and support preparedness activities that help communities anticipate and withstand emergencies and disasters, including the development and maintenance of emergency operations plans, the coordination of resources, and the promotion of individual and community preparedness; and

WHEREAS, during disasters and emergencies, local emergency management agencies coordinate response operations, support incident management, maintain situational awareness, facilitate communication among local, regional, state, and federal partners, and help deliver timely information to the public; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee communities have faced significant emergencies and disasters in recent years, to name only a handful among many, the Waverly floods, the 2020 tornadoes, the Gatlinburg wildfires, Tropical Storm Helene, and the January 2026 winter storm, and local emergency management personnel have consistently met these challenges with skill, courage, and determination; and

WHEREAS, following emergencies, local emergency management agencies play a critical role in recovery by assessing impacts, documenting damages, coordinating debris management and unmet needs, supporting disaster assistance programs, and helping communities rebuild stronger and more resilient than before; and

WHEREAS, the personnel of local emergency management agencies demonstrate professionalism, dedication, and selfless commitment, often working long hours under stressful conditions, to ensure Tennessee communities are prepared for, respond to, and recover from emergencies of all kinds; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the men and women, both past and present, of the local emergency management agencies of Tennessee for their meritorious service, extending our deepest appreciation for their dedication and commitment to a job well done.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.